

3.2 Shape Tools

Reference & Notes

FDD UNIT 3 · DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

NAME _____

DATE _____



Rectangle / Rounded Rectangle

Click-drag to draw; click once to type exact width/height. Drag a Live Shape's corner widget to round its corners without changing the underlying path.



Ellipse

Hold **Shift** for a perfect circle; hold **Option/Alt** to draw outward from the center point instead of a corner.



Polygon

Click-drag, then tap the **Up/Down arrow** keys while still dragging to add or remove sides.



Star

Same arrow-key trick adds/removes points; hold **Option/Alt** while dragging to keep the star's arms straight instead of curving inward.



Line Segment

Hold **Shift** to constrain to horizontal, vertical, or 45° angles.

1. A **Live Shape** remembers that it's a rectangle/ellipse/polygon and stays editable (corner radius, exact dimensions) — until you tell Illustrator to expand it into a plain path.
2. Every shape has a _____ box — the invisible rectangle that marks its full width and height, used when you scale or align it.

Try it: build a simple face or icon using only these five tools — no freehand drawing.